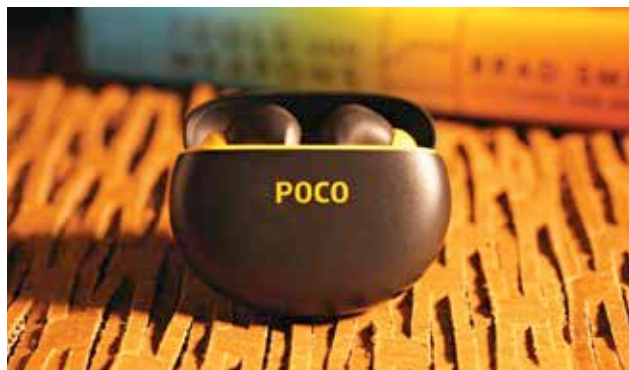




quite impressive when paired with the right-sized ear tips – and you get three options to choose from.

PERFORMANCE AND BATTERY LIFE

In terms of performance as well, these earbuds were almost the same as the Redmi Buds 4 Active. There was a noticeable boost in the bass frequencies, which meant that while the fans of bass-forward sound would love these earbuds and the thump that Bollywood, hip-hop, and related genres pack, the purists, or people who are listening to more vocal-forward music, wouldn't find the sound to be as appealing.

Now, as I said, if you are a fan of hip-hop or Bollywood music, then you would love these earbuds. These earbuds nail the sound signature required for bass-heavy tracks, and when I listened to tracks like Obsessed to draw parallels with the Buds 4 Active, my observations carried through. The track was well rounded with most instruments being clear and the track packing the thump that I assume the artist wanted to put in with this track.

The ENC worked similar to what I saw on the Redmi Buds 4 Active. While some of the sharper sounds like that of a mechanical keyboard and clicking of pens around the office were audible throughout, slightly more muted sounds like that of the AC, and similar droning sounds coming from our PC's fans were also drowned out by these earbuds.

The low latency mode was again responsible for a chunk of battery drain during my gaming sessions. However, it was effective, and coupled with the decent microphone performance of these earbuds during my gaming sessions, meant that I had a really nice experience overall, better than some of the similarly priced gaming earbuds.

As for the battery life, during my testing, it came in at around 4 hours and 20 minutes, which is 5 minutes more than what I had recorded on the Redmi Buds 4 Active. However, that can be attributed to the marginal errors that might have crept in during my battery drain test. The claimed battery life on these earbuds is 5 hours on a single charge, so the 40 minute deficit is something that I would keep an eye

on, but is certainly not a deal breaker at this price.

VERDICT

If you are out in the market for a pair of TWS earbuds under ₹1,500 then you can definitely go for the POCO Pods. These are retailing at ₹1,199 at the time of writing, and for that price, make for a great pair of entry-level TWS earbuds. The only real competition that they have is the Redmi Buds 4 Active, which I have spoken enough about in this review. They are selling at ₹1,399 at the time of writing, making the POCO Pods seem like a better deal. So, I would say, wishlist both these earbuds, and whichever comes down in price first during the sales, go for it!

–Satvik Pandey

SPECIFICATIONS

Bluetooth version: 5.3 | Battery life: 30 hrs | Charging time: 1.5 hours | 12mm Drivers | Upto 30 Hours of Playback | Fast Charge: 10 mins = 90 mins | Upto 60ms Low Latency | Google Fast Pair | ENC | IPX4 Water & Sweat Resistance

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